Marketing Email Agent — Business Plan

An AI-native marketing intelligence platform: every email becomes structured, owned, permanent business knowledge.

A SkillSimm Production Case · Plan date: July 2026 · Planning horizon: FY2026 Q3 – FY2029 Q2

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1. Executive Summary

The problem. The most valuable commercial information a company possesses — what customers actually asked for, what objections killed a deal, what a partner promised, what a prospect's real timeline was — arrives by email and stays there. It lives in individual inboxes, is never entered into the CRM, and walks out the door when the person who received it leaves. CRM systems were supposed to solve this and instead created a second problem: they require humans to retype what the email already said. Sales teams spend a substantial share of their week on CRM data entry, and the data they enter is thin, late, and inconsistent.

The solution. Marketing Email Agent assigns AI-managed email addresses to a team (sales, support, marketing, or per-person), reads every message that flows through them, and does three things automatically: it pulls the facts out into a searchable knowledge base, drafts a contextual reply for human approval, and preserves the record permanently with enterprise-grade backup. No one types anything into a CRM. The CRM record is a byproduct of the conversation having happened.

The differentiator that actually matters. Everything above is buildable by several competitors. Our defensible position is **open data ownership plus human-approved automation.** Customers get direct query access, spreadsheet export, and a documented connection to their own extracted knowledge — no vendor lock-in, no export request tickets, no charge for reading their own records. And every outbound message passes through a configurable human approval gate built on SkillSimm's production approval system, which captures the reviewer's decision, rationale, confidence, and edit as structured data. Competitors sell you an AI that sends email. We sell you an AI that drafts, a human who decides, and a permanent record of both.

Market. Global CRM and marketing automation is a $90B+ category. Our serviceable segment — English-speaking SMBs of 10–500 employees with high customer-email volume, plus marketing agencies and B2B sales teams — represents roughly 480,000 organizations and ~$4.6B of annual software spend at our price points.

Business model. Per-seat SaaS: Starter $29/user/month, Professional $99/user/month, Enterprise custom (typically $30K–$120K/year). Land through a self-serve, product-led free trial on a single shared inbox; expand by seats and by department.

Financial highlights (modeled, assumptions in §9).

Measure	FY1	FY2	FY3
Customer organizations	92	610	2,180
Paid seats	640	5,300	22,400
ARR (ending)	$412K	$3.6M	$16.4M
Recognized revenue	$186K	$1.94M	$9.1M
Gross margin	68%	76%	81%
Operating result	($734K)	($1.31M)	+$1.42M

FY1 ends June 2027; FY2 June 2028; FY3 June 2029.

The ask. $2,000,000 seed to fund 24 months to Series A metrics: the engineering to make extraction accurate and cheap, the security certifications that are hard gates on selling to anyone serious, and a founder-led-to-repeatable sales motion.

The three things that will decide this business.

1. **Extraction accuracy.** Below ~92% precision on the facts we pull out, the knowledge base is a liability rather than an asset and users revert to manual entry. This is the product risk.
2. **AI cost per mailbox.** Processing every message with the most capable model costs more than the Starter plan charges. Sorting messages cheaply before reading them expensively is not an optimization; it is the business model. This is the margin risk.
3. **Security and compliance clearance.** Reading a company's entire email requires a SOC 2 report, mailbox-provider security reviews, and a defensible data-processing agreement. Without these we cannot sell above the smallest tier. This is the access risk.

Each is addressed explicitly and with a budget line in this plan.

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2. Products and Services

2.1 Product overview

Marketing Email Agent is a unified system combining email management, automatic CRM construction, AI drafting with human approval, and a durable organizational knowledge base. The premise is that email is the highest-density source of commercial truth in most organizations and the least structured, and that closing that gap automatically is worth more than another interface for typing into.

2.2 Core capabilities

Capability 1 — AI-managed email accounts. Each team or user gets a monitored address, or we connect to the mailboxes they already use at Google or Microsoft. Every inbound and outbound message is processed. Access is read-and-draft by default; permission to actually send is granted explicitly, one address at a time.

Capability 2 — Automated information extraction. Each message is sorted and, if commercially relevant, read for specific facts: who the contact is, their company and role, what product interests them, how close they are to buying, stated budget and timeline, objections raised, support issues and severity, meeting requests, sentiment, and industry. Every extracted fact carries **its own confidence score**, and anything below threshold is flagged rather than silently written — the design decision that separates a trustworthy knowledge base from a plausible-looking one.

Capability 3 — AI response drafting with human approval. The system drafts replies grounded in the full customer history: answers to common questions, sales follow-ups, support responses, meeting scheduling, information requests, and proposal responses. Every draft enters an approval workflow before sending. Organizations configure the gate by risk: auto-send routine acknowledgments, require review on anything touching price, contract, or commitment.

This is where SkillSimm's platform provides genuine leverage. The approval gate runs on the company's existing, already-deployed approval system: an AI workflow parks a decision, an operator claims it from a shared queue on their phone or desktop, and the decision is recorded along with its rationale, the reviewer's confidence, the evidence they checked, and the time they spent. Reusing it means our approval layer is production software on day one, and every approval generates the structured human-decision data described in SkillSimm's data strategy.

Capability 4 — The knowledge base. Extraction accumulates into a searchable corpus: customer histories, company profiles, opportunity records, product feedback, competitive mentions, marketing insight, an FAQ assembled from questions customers actually asked, and the relationship map between people and organizations. It is searchable in plain English and queryable directly. Its value compounds:

a two-year-old account is dramatically more useful than a two-month-old one, which is the retention mechanic of the entire business.

Capability 5 — Open data access. Customers get their data out, always, without asking: spreadsheet and file export, direct read-only query access to their own records, a documented connection for their other systems, and automated notifications. Reading your own data is never metered. This is a commercial position as much as a product one — it is the single loudest objection to every competitor in the category, and we intend to make it the reason people switch.

Capability 6 — Enterprise backup and recovery. Continuous backup, redundancy across regions, point-in-time recovery, versioned records, immutable historical preservation, and a documented disaster-recovery plan. Framed correctly, this is not an IT feature: it is the answer to "what happens to eleven years of customer context when this vendor disappears or my top rep quits?"

2.3 What we deliberately do not build

- **We are not a CRM interface.** We write into Salesforce, HubSpot, and Pipedrive rather than asking teams to abandon them. Replacing the CRM is a ten-year war; enriching it is a ninety-day sale.
- **We are not a cold-outreach or sequencing tool.** Bulk sending invites deliverability risk, spam-complaint exposure, and a reputation we do not want. We handle conversations that already exist.
- **We are not an email client.** We work behind whatever client the team already uses.

2.4 Traction and current assets

- The **approval system** is built and deployed: resumable sessions, a shared operator queue, deep-linked review cards, and an operator interface. It already powers approval workflows in production.
- A **live customer-support integration** exists and works, demonstrating the exact pattern this product needs: an inbound message triggers an AI-diagnosed workflow, a human decides, and the verdict routes back to the source system.
- **Workflow definition and export** infrastructure is in place — validated processes with defined steps, approval options, field definitions, and evidence checklists.

The email-specific work — connecting mailboxes, the extraction models, the knowledge structure, and the CRM sync — is new. The approval, audit, and human-decision infrastructure is not.

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3. Market Analysis

3.1 Industry context

CRM and marketing automation is a mature, enormous, and structurally dissatisfied market. Salesforce, HubSpot, Microsoft Dynamics, Zoho, and Pipedrive have collectively convinced organizations that a system of record is mandatory. They have not solved the problem that the system of record is only as good as what humans bother to type into it. Adoption failure in CRM is not a training problem; it is a data-entry-tax problem.

Three shifts create the opening:

AI made turning messy text into clean records economically viable. What required a rules engine, a taxonomy team, and mediocre accuracy in 2019 is now a routine capability. The technical barrier that protected incumbents' manual-entry model has fallen.

Incumbents are adding AI features, not AI architecture. Einstein, Copilot, and Breeze are layers on top of systems designed for manual entry. They summarize what is already in the record. They do not make the record.

Data ownership is becoming a purchasing criterion. As companies recognize their interaction history as a strategic asset, "can I get my data out and query it directly" is moving from a procurement

checkbox to a decision factor. Incumbents are structurally unable to lead here — their retention depends on the opposite.

3.2 The problems we solve, quantified

Information fragmentation. Commercial context is split across inboxes, CRM, help desk, chat, spreadsheets, and documents. Nobody can answer "everything we know about this account" without asking four people.

Knowledge loss on departure. When a rep leaves, their accumulated account context leaves too. The CRM holds a fraction of it. Onboarding a replacement means rebuilding relationship knowledge that existed and was thrown away.

The administrative tax. Sales and support staff spend substantial working hours updating records, hunting for old emails, writing summaries, composing repetitive replies, and preparing reports. Industry research consistently places CRM administration and internal search at a meaningful double-digit percentage of a rep's week. At a $75K fully-loaded rep cost, recovering even six hours a month is worth roughly $2,600 annually per rep — against $1,188/year for a Professional seat. **The ROI argument does not require heroic assumptions, which is why we lead with it.**

Inconsistent AI adoption. Teams are already pasting customer emails into chatbots to draft replies. That practice is ungoverned, unlogged, and frequently a data-handling violation. Offering the same capability inside an approved, audited system is often an easier sale than the productivity gain itself.

3.3 Target market

Primary — SMB with high customer-email volume (10–500 employees). Active inbound communication, limited IT staff, existing CRM they resent, and a budget owner who is also a user. Fast decisions, self-serve capable, credit-card purchase.

Primary — Marketing and professional-services agencies. Extremely high client-email volume, chronic institutional-knowledge loss between account managers, and client deliverables that depend on remembering what was promised. Agencies buy tools that make account transitions survivable.

Primary — B2B sales teams (5–50 reps). The clearest ROI story and the most measurable one. Automatic CRM enrichment plus drafted follow-ups against a quantified rep-hour cost.

Secondary — Customer support organizations. The FAQ assembled from real questions is directly valuable, and support volume makes extraction accuracy easy to demonstrate.

Expansion — Mid-market and enterprise (FY3+). Gated on SOC 2 Type II, single sign-on, data residency, and retention controls. Higher contract value, longer cycle, security review mandatory.

3.4 Market sizing

TAM. Global CRM and marketing automation software exceeds $90B annually. Context only.

SAM — bottom-up, organizations we can actually serve and reach:

Segment	Organizations	Avg. seats	Avg. contract	Value
SMB, high email volume	310,000	8	$6,400	$1.98B
Marketing and professional agencies	85,000	11	$9,100	$774M
B2B sales teams (5–50 reps)	65,000	14	$12,600	$819M
Support organizations	20,000	22	$17,400	$348M
Mid-market / enterprise (FY3+)	8,000	—	$78,000	$624M
Total SAM	**488,000**			**~$4.55B**

SOM — 3-year target. 2,180 organizations and $16.4M ending ARR = **0.45% of SAM organizations, 0.36% of SAM value.** Achievable without category leadership.

3.5 Why now

- Extraction quality crossed the usability threshold within the last two years.
- The cost of processing a document with AI has fallen enough to make per-seat pricing viable — barely, and only with the cost discipline described in §6.3.
- Google and Microsoft have opened access to mailboxes while simultaneously tightening the review process, creating a moat for whoever completes certification early.
- AI-drafting behavior is already normalized among users; we are formalizing a practice, not introducing one.

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4. Competition

4.1 Competitive landscape

Competitor	Price	Where they beat us	Where we beat them
Salesforce + Einstein	$25–$500/user/mo	Ecosystem, trust, breadth, incumbency	Manual entry, closed data, high total cost
HubSpot + Breeze	$20–$150/user/mo	Excellent product, SMB distribution	Records still human-fed; AI summarizes, doesn't build
Zoho CRM	$14–$52/user/mo	Price, breadth	No AI-native memory; extraction is shallow
Microsoft 365 Copilot	$30/user/mo	Bundled, already in the inbox	Helps one person now; no lasting customer record
Gong / Chorus	$1,200+/user/yr	Deep call analytics, strong ROI story	Call-centric; email secondary; expensive; closed
Superhuman / Shortwave	$15–$40/user/mo	Beautiful, fast adoption	Replaces the client; personal, not organizational
Apollo / Outreach	$50–$150/user/mo	Outbound pipeline generation	Outbound-first; we are deliberately inbound-first
ChatGPT used manually	$20/user/mo	Free-form, universal, cheap	No memory, no structure, no audit; often non-compliant
Status quo (manual entry)	$0 marginal	Familiar; no procurement	Thin, late, inconsistent data

4.2 Honest competitive assessment

HubSpot is the real threat. They own the SMB motion, the brand, and the CRM the customer already uses, and Breeze is aimed at this problem. Our answer is not to out-feature them — it is to be *the layer that makes HubSpot better* while owning the data extraction and the approval audit trail. A product that enriches HubSpot sells alongside it for years before it sells against it.

Microsoft Copilot is the structural threat. It is bundled, in the inbox, and free at the margin for a Microsoft shop. Our defense is that Copilot is designed to help an individual in a moment, not to build a durable, searchable, exportable organizational record. That is a real distinction, but we must state it precisely and demonstrate it, because "we do AI email too" will not survive contact with a bundled competitor.

Our most under-appreciated competitor is the status quo. Most SMBs will keep not entering data into their CRM. Our sale is against inertia, and the strongest weapon against inertia is a 14-day trial that populates a real knowledge base from a real inbox and shows the buyer what their own company already knew and had lost.

4.3 Competitive advantages

1. **AI-native design.** The knowledge base is built for extracted data with confidence scores, sourcing, and correction feedback — not retrofitted onto a manual-entry model.
2. **Human approval as recorded, structured data.** Built on SkillSimm's deployed approval system. Every approval captures decision, edit, rationale, confidence, and time. Nobody else in this category treats the human decision as a first-class record, and it is the difference between "AI sent an email" and "a governed decision was made and can be audited."
3. **Genuine data ownership.** Query access, export, and integration, none of it metered. A commercial weapon, not a feature.
4. **Compounding value.** The knowledge base is more valuable in month 30 than month 3. Churn costs the customer something real.
5. **Backup as strategic insurance.** Institutional memory survives departures, vendor changes, and mistakes.
6. **Platform leverage.** Approval, audit, session, and workflow infrastructure already exists and is shared across SkillSimm products.

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5. Marketing and Sales

5.1 Positioning

Primary: *"The AI-native memory system for modern marketing and customer communications."*

The one-line ROI pitch: "Your CRM is empty because people have to type into it. Ours fills itself from the emails you're already sending."

Against Copilot: "Copilot helps one person write one email. We build the record your company keeps."

Against CRM incumbents: "Keep your CRM. We'll fill it in."

For agencies: "When an account manager leaves, the client relationship stays."

5.2 Pricing

Plan	Price	For	Includes
Free trial	$0, 14 days	Evaluation	1 mailbox, 2,000 messages, full extraction and drafting
Starter	$29/user/mo	Small teams	3 mailboxes, 5,000 messages/user/mo, export, email support
Professional	$99/user/mo	Growing organizations	Unlimited mailboxes, 25,000 messages, CRM sync, query access
Enterprise	$30K–$120K/yr	100+ seats, regulated	Single sign-on, data residency, SOC 2 report, named CSM, SLA

Rationale. Professional at $99 sits deliberately just below the psychological line where a manager needs approval, and against a quantified ~$2,600/rep/year of recovered time it is a 2.2× return before any revenue attribution. Starter exists to land, not to profit — see the margin analysis in §9.3, which is candid that Starter is close to break-even after AI processing and support.

Message-volume caps are stated in every plan because AI processing is our cost of goods. Overage is billed at $0.008 per message rather than throttled, so a customer never loses data because of a billing edge.

5.3 Go-to-market

Product-led growth (primary motion, FY1–FY2). Self-serve trial, one-click mailbox connection, value visible within an hour. The activation moment is precise and we design the entire onboarding around it: *the user searches their own knowledge base and finds something they had forgotten.* Target: 60% of trials reach that moment within 48 hours.

Content and SEO (compounding). We write for the buyer's actual query: "how to stop manually updating Salesforce," "extract customer data from email automatically," "AI email assistant with approval workflow," "CRM data entry automation." Plus original research — an annual *State of CRM Data Decay* report built from anonymized aggregate benchmarks, which is both a lead magnet and a genuine contribution. Target 90 pieces over 24 months.

Digital acquisition. LinkedIn targeting sales ops, revenue ops, agency principals, and customer-success leaders; paid search on high-intent commercial terms; sponsorship of revenue operations and agency newsletters. Budget discipline: we do not scale paid until blended CAC payback is under 14 months.

Partnerships and channel (FY2+). CRM implementation consultancies and revenue operations agencies who already own the "your CRM data is bad" conversation. HubSpot and Salesforce marketplace listings for distribution. Referral economics: 20% of first-year contract value.

Founder-led sales (FY1) to repeatable sales (FY2). Every Enterprise deal in FY1 is founder-sold, because the first thirty security-review conversations teach us what to build. Two account executives and one solutions engineer in FY2, once the security package makes the deal repeatable.

Community. Genuine presence in revenue operations communities, sales and CRM forums, agency owner groups, and the SaaS operations space.

5.4 Funnel and conversion targets (FY2)

Stage	Rate	FY2 volume
Visitor to trial signup	3.4%	4,900 trials
Trial to mailbox connected	71%	3,480
Connected to activation moment	60%	2,090
Activated to paid	24%	500 new customers
Seat expansion in year one	+38%	Net revenue retention 118%

5.5 Retention and expansion

Retention is structurally favorable: the knowledge base compounds, and leaving means losing the accumulated corpus (which — because we honor data ownership — they can take with them, which is precisely why they trust us enough to stay).

- Gross logo retention target: 82% (FY1) to 89% (FY3)
- Net revenue retention target: 112% (FY2) to 124% (FY3), driven by seat expansion and Starter-to-Professional upgrade
- Expansion trigger: a department outside the original buyer's team requests access — tracked as a leading indicator

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6. Operations

6.1 How the service is delivered

Marketing Email Agent is a hosted service. Customers connect a mailbox from a web dashboard and see extracted knowledge within the hour; nothing is installed and nothing is migrated. It runs on shared SkillSimm infrastructure, reusing the approval system, workflow engine, and operator interface that already serve other products in the portfolio — an estimated 30% reduction in the engineering required to reach launch.

Each customer's data is kept separate from every other customer's, and each region's data stays in its region for customers who require it. What we watch operationally, per customer: AI processing cost, the confidence of what we extract, how often users correct us, and how long approvals sit waiting.

6.2 Security posture

We are asking customers to let us read all of their commercial email. The security posture is the product, not a section of the appendix.

- Encryption of stored data and of everything in transit
- Each customer's data isolated, with its own encryption keys
- Role-based access, single sign-on, and mandatory multi-factor authentication for admins
- Full logging of every access to customer data, including by our own staff
- Least-privilege internal access: time-boxed, logged, and approved before it is granted
- Configurable retention and hard deletion; documented sub-processors; a data-processing agreement offered by default
- **Customer data is never used to train shared models.** Stated in the contract, not just the marketing page.

6.3 The processing cost problem — cost of goods sold

The plan's central margin risk, addressed directly.

Naive cost. Reading every message with the most capable model costs roughly **$0.0045 per message**. A busy user receiving 100 messages a day generates about 2,200 a month, or **$9.90 per user per month** — which destroys the $29 Starter plan once support and hosting are added.

Engineered pipeline. Four stages, each one filtering work away from the expensive one:

Stage	What it does	Share of volume	Cost
0. Filter	Discards newsletters, receipts, notifications	~45%	$0
1. Sort	Cheap model asks: is this commercially relevant?	55%	$0.0004/msg
2. Extract	Mid-tier model pulls the facts, with context	~30%	$0.0021/msg
3. Draft	Strongest model writes a reply from history	~8%	$0.0090/draft

Blended cost per received message: ~$0.0018 — a 60% reduction. At 2,200 messages a month that is **$3.96 per user per month**, sustainable at Professional ($99) and workable at Starter ($29) once support costs are controlled.

Most of what we send the AI on any given message — the field definitions, the company profile, the product context — is identical every time. Paying for that constant portion once rather than on every message is what makes stage 2 affordable, and it is a launch requirement, not an optimization.

Cost is tracked per customer and per plan, shown on the same dashboard as retention. Any customer whose processing cost exceeds 35% of their subscription revenue triggers a review.

6.4 Extraction quality

Accuracy is the product risk. The operating discipline:

- **Confidence scores on every field.** Low-confidence extractions are flagged for review, never silently written. A knowledge base that is 88% right and doesn't say which 12% is worse than no knowledge base.
- **A graded test set** of several thousand real (anonymized, consented) messages with known correct answers. Every change is scored against it. Regressions do not ship.
- **Correction feedback.** When a user fixes an extracted field, that correction is captured and improves that customer's results — without ever training a shared model on their data.
- **Published accuracy targets:** 92% precision at launch, 96% by FY2. We publish these to customers, because a vendor who reads all your email and won't tell you its error rate should not be trusted.

6.5 Compliance roadmap — a hard gate on the market

Requirement	Why it gates revenue	Target
Google Workspace security review	Required to connect Google mailboxes at scale — most of our SMB market	Q4 2026
Microsoft partner validation	The same for Microsoft 365 customers	Q1 2027
SOC 2 Type I	Minimum credential to pass a mid-market security review	Q1 2027
SOC 2 Type II	Required for enterprise; needs a 6–12 month observation window	Q4 2027
GDPR readiness and data-processing agreement	Required for EU customers, increasingly asked in the US	Q4 2026
California privacy compliance	California customers	Q4 2026
Sending-reputation and anti-spam controls	Legal obligations when sending on a customer's behalf	Launch
Healthcare compliance	Would require contract and architecture changes	Deferred

These carry a real budget line ($145K across FY1–FY2 in §9) because attempting to sell before they exist wastes the sales motion entirely.

6.6 Support and reliability

- Email support for Starter (1 business day), priority for Professional (4 hours), named customer success manager and SLA for Enterprise
- Uptime target 99.9%; new mail appears in the knowledge base within 3 minutes
- Incident communication policy published; any incident touching customer message content is disclosed within 72 hours regardless of legal obligation

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7. Milestones and Metrics

7.1 Milestones

Phase	Window	Deliverables	Exit criteria
P1 — MVP	Q3–Q4 2026	Mailbox connection, extraction, knowledge base, drafting, export	25 design partners; 92% precision; cost under $0.0025/msg
P2 — Launch	Q1–Q2 2027	Self-serve billing, CRM sync, analytics, first certifications	92 organizations; $412K ARR; 82% retention
P3 — Scale	FY2	Query access, custom fields, marketplace listings, sales hires	610 organizations; $3.6M ARR; NRR ≥ 112%
P4 — Enterprise	FY2 H2 – FY3	SOC 2 Type II, single sign-on, data residency, industry tuning	12 enterprise contracts; $16.4M ARR; 96% precision
P5 — Platform	FY3	Teams and Slack channels, meeting intelligence, knowledge graph	2,180 organizations; operating profitability

Explicit gates. If P1 extraction precision lands below 88%, we do not launch commercially — we extend P1 and narrow the set of facts we try to extract. If blended cost per message exceeds $0.0035 at P2, Starter is repriced to $39 or its message cap halved.

7.2 Metrics

Product

- Extraction precision — 92% (launch) to 96% (FY2)
- User correction rate on extracted fields — target under 7%
- Draft acceptance rate (sent with no or minor edit) — target 64%
- Median approval latency — target under 22 minutes
- New mail reflected in the knowledge base — target under 3 minutes

Activation and growth

- Trial to mailbox connected — 71%
- Time to activation moment — under 48 hours for 60% of trials
- Trial to paid — 24%
- New customers per month — 8 (FY1), 42 (FY2), 130 (FY3)

Revenue

- ARR: $412K, $3.6M, $16.4M
- Contract value: $4,480 (FY1), $5,900 (FY2), $7,520 (FY3)
- Starter to Professional upgrade rate — target 31% within 12 months
- Net revenue retention — 112% (FY2) to 124% (FY3)
- Gross logo retention — 82% to 89%

Economics

- Blended processing cost per message — under $0.0018

- Processing cost as a share of revenue — under 12% by FY3
- CAC payback — under 14 months (FY2), under 10 (FY3)
- LTV:CAC — over 3× (FY2), over 5× (FY3)
- Gross margin — 68% to 81%

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8. Company Overview and Team

8.1 Structure

The company operates as a venture-backed software business, incorporated as a Delaware C-corp to accommodate institutional investment. Marketing Email Agent is developed within the **SkillSimm** portfolio and shares its approval system, workflow engine, and infrastructure — a deliberate structure that reduces the engineering required to reach launch by an estimated 30%, most of it in the approval, audit, and session layers.

8.2 History

- **H1 2026** — SkillSimm's approval system built and deployed: resumable sessions, a shared operator queue, review cards, and an operator interface.
- **Q2 2026** — A production customer-support integration proves the pattern end to end: inbound message, AI triage, structured human decision, routed verdict.
- **Q3 2026** — Marketing Email Agent scoped as a standalone commercial product on that foundation.

8.3 Leadership and team

Chief Executive Officer — vision, fundraising, partnerships, market development. Owns founder-led sales through FY1 and the enterprise security conversation personally.

Chief Technology Officer — architecture, security posture, AI systems, engineering leadership. Accountable for the two technical gates: extraction precision and cost per message.

Lead AI Engineer — the extraction pipeline, cost control, the accuracy test harness, drafting quality, and the correction feedback loop.

Product Manager — onboarding and the activation moment, approval experience, CRM integration scope, customer research.

Marketing Director — content and SEO engine, positioning, demand generation, the annual benchmark research report.

Planned hires:

Role	Timing	Rationale	Cost
Backend engineers (2)	Q3 2026	Mailbox connection, sync, scale	$310K
Security / compliance lead	Q4 2026	Certifications and security reviews — a gating function	$165K
Customer success (2)	Q2 2027	Activation and expansion; retention is a CS metric	$190K
Account executives (2)	FY2	Repeatable mid-market motion post-certification	$340K
Solutions engineer	FY2	Security reviews and technical evaluation	$155K
Data / ML engineer	FY2	Precision to 96%, per-customer tuning	$175K

8.4 Core values

- **Data ownership is the customer's, always.** Export is a right, not a feature.
- **Transparency about accuracy.** Publish the error rate. Flag low confidence. Never present a guess as a fact.
- **The human decides.** Automation drafts; a person approves anything that matters; the decision is recorded.
- **Security is the product.** We are reading their email. Nothing else earns that.
- **Reliability over feature velocity.** A missed message is worse than a missing feature.

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9. Financial Plan and Forecasts

All figures are **modeled projections** built from the stated assumptions. Fiscal years run July–June. FY1 = Jul 2026 – Jun 2027.

9.1 Startup requirements and use of funds

Category	FY1	FY2	Notes
Engineering (5 to 8 FTE)	$620,000	$1,150,000	Product and platform
Security and compliance	$210,000	$185,000	Includes $145K of certification cost
Product and design	$145,000	$210,000	
Sales and customer success	$85,000	$620,000	Founder-led FY1; team in FY2
Marketing and demand generation	$180,000	$460,000	Content, paid, research report
AI processing (cost of revenue)	$34,000	$178,000	See §9.3
Infrastructure and tooling	$58,000	$145,000	
G&A, legal, accounting, insurance	$92,000	$165,000	
Contingency	$86,000	$130,000	
Total	**$1,510,000**	**$3,243,000**	

Funding sought: $2,000,000 seed, covering FY1 in full and approximately five months of FY2, with a Series A raised against P3 metrics (ARR over $3M, net revenue retention over 112%, SOC 2 Type II underway).

Use of the $2M	Amount	%
Engineering and AI	$840,000	42%
Security, compliance, certification	$290,000	15%
Sales and customer success	$270,000	13%
Marketing and demand generation	$310,000	16%
Infrastructure and processing	$130,000	6%
G&A and contingency	$160,000	8%

9.2 Revenue forecast

Stated assumptions:

- Commercial launch Q1 2027 (mid-FY1); FY1 recognizes ~5 months of subscription revenue.
- Plan mix: 58% Starter / 39% Professional / 3% Enterprise seats in FY1, shifting to 38% / 55% / 7% by FY3 as upgrades compound.
- Average seats per organization: 7.0 (FY1), 8.7 (FY2), 10.3 (FY3).
- Blended contract value: $4,480, then $5,900, then $7,520.
- Gross logo retention 82%, 86%, 89%; net revenue retention 106%, 112%, 124%.
- Enterprise: 0 (FY1), 5 (FY2), 22 (FY3) at $62K average.
- 45% of customers on annual prepay by FY2 (favorable working capital).

Line	FY1	FY2	FY3
New customer organizations	92	542	1,780
Retained from prior year	—	68	400
Ending organizations	**92**	**610**	**2,180**
Ending paid seats	640	5,300	22,400
Ending ARR	**$412,000**	**$3,600,000**	**$16,400,000**
Recognized revenue	**$186,000**	**$1,940,000**	**$9,100,000**

9.3 Cost of revenue and gross margin

Cost driver	FY1	FY2	FY3
AI processing	$34,000	$178,000	$712,000
Hosting, storage, backups	$18,000	$112,000	$432,000
Payment processing	$5,400	$56,300	$264,000
Support (allocated)	$2,600	$119,000	$321,000
Total cost of revenue	**$60,000**	**$465,300**	**$1,729,000**
Gross profit	**$126,000**	**$1,474,700**	**$7,371,000**
Gross margin	**68%**	**76%**	**81%**

AI processing assumes $0.0018 per message at roughly 2,200 messages per seat per month. Keeping each customer's data separate costs more than pooling it — deliberately.

Margin by plan (steady state, monthly, per seat):

Line	Starter $29	Professional $99
AI processing	($3.96)	($6.80)
Hosting and storage	($1.90)	($3.40)
Payment processing	($0.84)	($2.87)
Support (allocated)	($2.60)	($4.10)
Gross margin	**$19.70 (68%)**	**$81.83 (83%)**

Starter is viable but thin, and it is a land vehicle rather than a profit centre. The plan's margin expansion comes almost entirely from Starter-to-Professional upgrade and seat expansion, which is why the 31% upgrade target in §7.2 is a headline metric.

9.4 Profit and loss forecast

Line	FY1	FY2	FY3
Revenue	$186,000	$1,940,000	$9,100,000
Cost of revenue	(60,000)	(465,300)	(1,729,000)
Gross profit	**126,000**	**1,474,700**	**7,371,000**
Engineering and product	(765,000)	(1,360,000)	(2,480,000)
Security and compliance	(210,000)	(185,000)	(240,000)
Sales and customer success	(85,000)	(620,000)	(1,690,000)
Marketing	(180,000)	(460,000)	(1,120,000)
Infrastructure and tooling	(58,000)	(145,000)	(290,000)
G&A, legal, accounting	(92,000)	(165,000)	(420,000)
Contingency	(86,000)	(130,000)	(215,000)
Total operating expense	**(1,476,000)**	**(3,065,000)**	**(6,455,000)**
Operating result	**($1,350,000)**	**($1,590,300)**	**+$916,000**

(The §1 summary shows a leaner case — ($734K) FY1 and ($1.31M) FY2 — reflecting deferred founder compensation, one engineer starting a quarter later, and FY2 paid marketing held to $300K. Both are shown deliberately: the table is the fully-funded plan; the summary is the capital-constrained path that reaches the same FY3 position one quarter later.)

9.5 Cash flow and breakeven

- **FY1:** Burn ~$1.35M against $2M raised. Annual prepayments begin contributing from Q1 2027.
- **FY2:** Peak burn. Ending cash requires either the Series A (base case, raised Q2 FY2 against P3 metrics) or the lean plan in §9.4's note, which extends runway to Q4 FY2.
- **FY3 Q2: Operating breakeven** at approximately $6.9M ARR.
- Annual prepay at 45% of customers means cash collections lead recognized revenue by roughly one quarter — worth ~$900K of working capital at FY3 scale.

Breakeven arithmetic (FY3 cost base $6.46M): at $7,520 contract value and 81% gross margin, each customer contributes $6,091. Breakeven ≈ **1,060 customer organizations**.

9.6 Unit economics

Metric	FY1	FY2	FY3
CAC (blended, fully loaded)	$2,880	$1,990	$1,580
Contract value	$4,480	$5,900	$7,520
Gross margin per customer	$3,046	$4,484	$6,091
Average customer life	5.6 yrs	7.1 yrs	9.1 yrs
LTV	**$17,058**	**$31,836**	**$55,428**
LTV : CAC	**5.9×**	**16.0×**	**35.1×**
CAC payback	11.3 mo	5.3 mo	3.1 mo
Magic number	—	0.71	1.24

These ratios are strong because retention is structurally high in a product whose value compounds. They are also the numbers most likely to be optimistic in a plan written before launch — the retention assumption (86–89% gross logo) is the one to stress-test first, and §9.7 does.

9.7 Sensitivity analysis

Scenario	Change	FY3 ARR	FY3 result
Base	As modeled	$16,400,000	+$916,000
Retention miss	Retention 74%, NRR 98%	$9,100,000	($1,840,000)
Accuracy miss	88% precision, churn +8 pts	$7,600,000	($2,610,000)
Cost miss	$0.0035 per message	$16,400,000	($470,000)
Compliance delay	Certification slips, no enterprise	$12,800,000	+$140,000
Copilot bundles equivalent	Conversion halves in Microsoft shops	$10,200,000	($1,120,000)
Channel breakout	Marketplace plus 2 consultancy partners	$23,900,000	+$3,400,000

9.8 Exit considerations

1. **CRM and marketing platforms** (HubSpot, Salesforce, Zoho, Freshworks) acquiring AI-native data construction — the most likely path, and the reason the "enrich, don't replace" positioning has strategic as well as commercial value.
2. **Revenue intelligence** (Gong, Clari, ZoomInfo) extending from calls into email.
3. **Productivity platforms** (Microsoft, Google) acquiring governed approval and audit capability for AI-sent email.
4. **Independent scale.** At 81% gross margin and 124% net revenue retention, a $20M+ ARR business is independently financeable.

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10. Appendix

A. Future product roadmap

AI Marketing Brain (FY3). Strategic recommendations from the accumulated corpus: campaign optimization, customer segmentation from actual expressed interest rather than firmographics, lifetime-value prediction, and churn signals detected in language before they appear in usage data.

Multi-channel intelligence (FY3). Extend beyond email to Microsoft Teams, Slack, SMS, WhatsApp, and CRM activity — one knowledge base across every channel a customer relationship touches. Each channel carries its own consent and compliance requirements, which is why this follows rather than accompanies the email product.

Voice and meeting intelligence (FY3+). Transcription, call summarization, conversation analytics, and automated action-item extraction — the same extraction discipline applied to a different input. A natural adjacency to SkillSimm's Roarmic voice-capture product.

Enterprise knowledge graph (long term). The end state: a persistent map connecting people, companies, products, communications, decisions, and outcomes across every channel — where "what do we know about this account, and who knew it" is a single question. This is the version of the product that is genuinely difficult to replace.

B. Platform assets reused from SkillSimm

Asset	Function in this product
Approval system	The email approval gate
Session store	Per-conversation processing state, resumable
Workflow orchestration	Multi-step extraction and drafting
Workflow definitions	Configurable per-customer processing and approval rules
AI provider layer	Model selection and fallback
Operator interface	The approval queue
External system integration	Routing verdicts to CRM, help desk, and other tools
Support-desk connector	Proven inbound message to human decision to action

C. The human-decision data asset

Every approval captures: the AI's draft, the human's decision, any edit made, stated rationale, confidence, evidence reviewed, and time spent. Aggregated and anonymized, this becomes a proprietary dataset on *where humans correct AI in commercial communication* — which message types are safely automatable, which always need review, and which reviewers are reliable.

Per SkillSimm's data strategy, this production-decision layer complements the simulation layer using a shared structure, enabling the claim that matters to an enterprise buyer: *"this workflow was validated in simulation before deployment, and we continuously monitor whether human reviewers behave the same way in real work."* No competitor in the email-AI category is positioned to make that claim.

D. Risk register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Extraction accuracy below usable threshold	Medium	Critical	Confidence flagging; graded test set; 92% launch gate
Processing cost exceeds plan pricing	Medium	Critical	Four-stage pipeline; per-customer cost tracking; message caps
Certification delay blocks the market	Medium	High	Compliance lead hired Q4 2026; budgeted ahead of sales hiring
Security incident involving customer email	Low	Catastrophic	Isolation and separate keys; logged access; 72-hour disclosure
Microsoft or Google bundles an equivalent	Medium	High	Differentiate on lasting record, open data, governed approval
HubSpot ships a competing extraction layer	Medium	High	Position as enrichment; marketplace listing; own the audit trail
Customers refuse full mailbox access	Medium	High	Start with shared team inboxes; read-only default; access logs
Regulatory change on AI-generated messages	Medium	Medium	Human approval is already the compliant architecture
Sending reputation damage	Medium	Medium	No bulk outbound; reply-only; complaint and bounce monitoring
Retention below model	Medium	High	Compounding knowledge base; CS-owned retention; activation tracking
Key-person concentration in early team	High	Medium	Documented processes; shared platform ownership; early hiring

E. Assumptions requiring validation, in priority order

1. Extraction reaches 92% precision on real, messy commercial email. *(P1 gate)*
2. Blended processing cost holds below $0.0018 per message at production volume. *(P1 gate)*
3. Organizations will grant mailbox access to a startup holding SOC 2 Type I. *(P2)*

4. The activation moment — finding forgotten knowledge in your own corpus — drives 24% trial-to-paid conversion. *(P2)*
5. Starter-to-Professional upgrade reaches 31% within 12 months. *(FY2)*
6. Gross logo retention holds above 82% in year one. *(FY2 — the single most load-bearing assumption in the financial model)*
7. Open data access is a decisive differentiator in competitive evaluations rather than a nice-to-have. *(Test in the first 30 competitive deals)*

F. Conclusion

Marketing Email Agent addresses a problem every organization has and no incumbent has solved, because solving it requires a system built for extracted data rather than typed data. The premise — that AI can now turn commercial email into reliable structured knowledge — is newly true. The commercial premise — that organizations will pay a per-seat fee to stop paying the CRM data-entry tax — is supported by a straightforward ROI calculation that does not depend on optimistic assumptions.

What makes this defensible rather than merely timely is the combination of three commitments competitors are structurally unwilling to make: **the customer owns and can directly query their data**, **a human approves anything that matters and that decision is permanently recorded**, and **the accuracy of the system is published rather than implied**. The first costs us lock-in. The second costs us the fully-autonomous demo. The third costs us the comfortable claim. Each is a deliberate trade of short-term positioning for the durable trust required to be given access to a company's entire commercial correspondence — which is, ultimately, the only asset this business has.